

What are the required skill sets?

For Animators:

Somil Gupta, Managing Director, Trine Studios: “For this role we look at people who can sketch and paint. On top of this we look for people who have explored art-styles from all over the world. In the past, we have seen that when we ask an artist to create a western-styled character, they just cannot pull it off. This is because they haven’t practiced their hand at different design styles and have stuck to what they learnt in art school,” points out Somil Gupta, the Managing Director at Trine Studios in Mumbai.

Vinod AS, the National Head of Academics with Toonz Academy says that besides people who can just draw, the animators who have the real advantage are those that have acting skills. That’s right. You read that right. Acting. “The animator himself is an actor. We’ve noticed that the students that are good at mimicry tend to make better animators. They could be very bad artists, but if they can act, they still make excellent animators. Let’s say he wants to design a monkey. Then the artist should be able to imitate the way a monkey walks and behave to be able to recreate it,” he says.

“You just cannot ask the computer to come up with, let’s say, a Victorian steampunk spaceship or a psycho-killer alien-robot assassin. You need artists to create this content and since we are rapidly approaching the point, if not surpassed it, where one can almost interchange the experience of watching a film or playing the newest chapter of the Resident Evil franchise. So we offer instructors that have industry experience in how to make a texture for that evil castle or create a walk-cycle for the muscle-bound hero for the latest and newest video game release,” says Philip Edward Alexy, professor at Picasso Animation, touching upon animation in video games.

For Game Production:

Vitek Goyal, CEO Pixeltek: Not necessarily a Master of Fine Arts degree. Diplomas, tutorials are great to have, but it’s the interest that you take in it.

Christopher Erhardt, founder Indian School of Gaming points out that candidates should focus on their math and English. The reason for this is that most game programming is math and all the major programming languages currently are in English.

Also, strong C/C++ programming at all levels coupled with good knowledge of linear algebra, calculus, written English and some skills at Flash/BREW/Java in addition to the C++ is needed for game programming. C# is as an emerging language for this space as well.

What is the required mind set?

- Having the desire to learn

Employers in India

Animation:

Toonz Animation India,
Thiruvananthapuram
Pentamedia Graphics, Chennai
Maya Entertainment, Mumbai
UTV Toonz, Mumbai

Heart Entertainment
Padmalaya Telefilms, Mumbai
Nipuna Services Ltd.
Jadoo Works, Bangalore
Crest Communications, Mumbai
Silvertoon Studio, Mumbai
DQE, Hyderabad

Gaming:

Aurora
Trine
FX Labs
Exigent
Pixeltek
Zapak Digital Entertainment Ltd.